

YHWH - GOD'S "MEMORIAL-NAME" (ZEKER)

A Paper

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There are so many names given in the Bible for God, but there is only one that would be referred to as His personal name. It could be described as the most unique of all the names of God. Exodus 3:15 says of it: “This is My name forever; this is how I am to be remembered in every generation.”¹ As this most special name is surveyed, discovery can be made of its distribution, definition, description, and direction.

Distribution

The name YHWH is found close to 7,000 times in the Bible, 6,828 to be exact. It is found these 6,828 times specifically in the Old Testament.² It is first found in Genesis 2:4³ where it states: “These are the records of the heavens and the earth, concerning their creation at the time that the LORD God made the earth and the heavens.”⁴ God is referred to as YHWH a total of 163 times in Genesis and over a 1,000 times (1,141) in the Pentateuch.⁵ It is used frequently in Psalms and the history books and quite frequently in Isaiah, Jeremiah, and Ezekiel of the

¹ Holman Christian Standard Bible. (Nashville: Holman Bible Publishers, 2009.)

² Vine, W. E., Merrill F. Unger, and William White, Jr. *Vine's Complete Expository Dictionary of Old and New Testament Words*. (Nashville: Thomas Nelson Publishers, 1996), 140.

³ Ibid.

⁴ Holman Christian Standard Bible.

⁵ Zondervan NASB Exhaustive Concordance. (Grand Rapids: Zondervan Publishing House, 2000), 664-669.

prophets.⁶

The usage of the name YHWH goes as far back as Adam and Eve. It was used by Eve in Genesis 4:1⁷ when she says, “I have had a male child with the LORD’s help.”⁸ The worship of YHWH is first referred to at the end of the same chapter in verse 26⁹: “A son was born to Seth also, and he named him Enosh. At that time people began to call on the name of Yahweh.”¹⁰ Enosh was the grandson of Adam and Eve, Seth being their son.¹¹ Further into the Pentateuch, God expressed specifically to Moses in Exodus 3:14 that He is to be referred to as “I AM” which is actually a slight variation of YHWH (“the LORD”).¹² It is in just the next verse that God says that YHWH is His “name forever” and that it is to be His “memorial-name to all generations.”¹³ The name “I AM” is specifically alluded to with what would appear to be intentionality several times in the New Testament writings of John, specifically in John and Revelation.¹⁴

The Jews were very careful how they used the name, YHWH, to the point some would say

⁶ Koehler, Ludwig and Walter Baumgartner. *The Hebrew and Aramaic Lexicon of the Old Testament*. (Leiden: Brill, 2001), 395.

⁷ Ryrie, Charles C. *Basic Theology*. (Chicago: Moody Press, 1999), 53.

⁸ Holman Christian Standard Bible.

⁹ Vine, *Vine’s Complete Expository Dictionary of Old and New Testament Words*, 140.

¹⁰ Holman Christian Standard Bible.

¹¹ Ibid., Genesis 4:25.

¹² *Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia*. Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1984.

¹³ New American Standard Bible. (La Habra: The Lockman Foundation, 1995.)

¹⁴ www.biblegateway.com,
<http://www.biblegateway.com/keyword/?search=%22I+am%22&version1=NASB&searchtype=phrase&spanbegin=50&spanend=73&resultspp=250&displayas=long&sort=bookorder>,
 (accessed December 5, 2012).

they “had a superstitious dread of using it.”¹⁵ One of the bases for this would be the third of the Ten Commandments, which reads: “You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain, for the LORD will not leave him unpunished who takes His name in vain.”¹⁶ To the degree that they took it was specifically based on Leviticus 24:16: “He that nameth the name of Yahweh shall surely be put to death.”¹⁷ When reading the Scripture publicly, they would substitute another name for YHWH such as *'Adonai* (“Lord”) or *'Elohim* (“God”).¹⁸ This thinking did not necessarily appear until after the Babylonian exile.¹⁹ The name YHWH “was ‘regularly pronounced’ . . . at least until 586 BC (when the Babylonian exile began).”²⁰

This sacred name of God appears in “every period of Biblical Hebrew.”²¹ It also has made its appearance in many non-Biblical writings.²² Examples of this are those such as the earliest, the Mesha inscription, and others such as the Lachish letters and Aramaic texts from Egypt.²³

¹⁵ Berkhof, L. *Systematic Theology*. (Grand Rapids: Wm. B. Eerdmans Publishing Co., 1949), 49.

¹⁶ Holman Christian Standard Bible, Exodus 20:7.

¹⁷ Berkhof, *Systematic Theology*, 49.

¹⁸ *Ibid.*

¹⁹ Ryrie, *Basic Theology*, 53-54.

²⁰ Clendenen, E. Ray. “Holman Christian Standard Bible (HCSB).” Pages 117-156. *Which Bible Translation Should I Use?: A Comparison of 4 Major Recent Versions*. Editors Andreas J. Köstenberger and David O. Croteau. (Nashville: B & H Academic, 2012), 154.

²¹ Vine, *Vine's Complete Expository Dictionary of Old and New Testament Words*, 140.

²² Koehler, *The Hebrew and Aramaic Lexicon of the Old Testament*, 395.

²³ Botterweck, G. Johannes and Helmer Ringgren. *Theological Dictionary of the Old Testament*. (Grand Rapids / Cambridge: William B. Eerdmans Publishing Company, 1986), 502-504.

Definition

What exactly is this name, and what does it mean? In short, it is “the personal name of God.” The idea of it being God’s personal name, would be the difference between saying to someone, “Hey, Bob...” rather than simply saying, “Hey, sir...” when yet his personal name was Bob. Rather than just simply calling God, “God,” it offers the provision to address Him by His very own personal name, YHWH.²⁴

Knowing that YHWH is designated as God’s personal name, how is it defined? What does it mean? In Hebrew culture, names had great significance. A name was not just a name. In Hebrew culture a name was considered an “embodiment of the person bearing it.”²⁵ God’s name, YHWH, was not just any random name that God just happened to pick for Himself because it was popular, simply because it was unique, because it was a family name, or because He liked the way it sounded as we do in our own way, in our own culture. He selected it because it had a specific significance, a specific meaning.²⁶

There is a few different views as to what the name YHWH means. YHWH is thought to be from one of two different Hebrew words, either hayah or hawah.²⁷ These two words seem interchangeable, being either synonyms or different forms of the same word; they both have essentially the same meaning: hawah - “to become, come to pass, be” / hayah - “to come to pass,

²⁴ Ibid., 500.

²⁵ Erickson, Millard J. Christian Theology, Second Edition. (Grand Rapids: Baker Academic, 1998), 296.

²⁶ Ibid.

²⁷ Brown, Francis, S. R. Driver, and Charles A. Briggs. The Brown-Driver-Briggs Hebrew and English Lexicon. (Peabody: Hendrickson Publishers, Inc., 2001), 218.

become, be.”²⁸ Accordingly, a connection was made between the name YHWH and the Hebrew verb hayah with the title (“I AM”) God labels Himself with in the Exodus 3:14.²⁹ It is possible that the name YHWH originated from the verb hawah being possibly a prior form of the word hayah.³⁰ Potentially, the word hawah was not at that time used so much as it formerly had been in maybe the time of its original usage (Genesis 4:1, 26) and that maybe hayah was more commonly used if not solely used.³¹

In Exodus 3:14, Arthur Pink says all tenses of the verb, “to be” is found: “I was, I am, and I shall always continue to be.”³² Wayne Grudem says that the name YHWH “suggests a continual present existence: God is the eternal ‘I AM,’ the one who eternally exists.”³³ Varying definitions are given for the name YHWH: “the active, self-existent One,”³⁴ “the creator of all that exists,” the One who is “immutable in his being and character,” or the One who is “eternal in His Existence.”³⁵ The Brown-Driver-Briggs Hebrew and English Lexicon suggests “the one bringing into being, life-giver...*giver of existence, creator...he who brings to pass...performer of promises*” or “the existing, ever-living, as self-consistent and unchangeable...the one ever

²⁸ Zondervan NASB Exhaustive Concordance. (Grand Rapids: Zondervan Publishing House, 2000), 1383.

²⁹ Berkhof, Systematic Theology, 49.

³⁰ Ibid.

³¹ Ibid.

³² Pink, Arthur W. Gleanings in Exodus. (Chicago: Moody Press, 1981), 29.

³³ Systematic Theology. (Grand Rapids: Zondervan, 1994), 169.

³⁴ Ryrie, Basic Theology, 53.

³⁵ ESV Study Bible. (Wheaton: Crossway Bibles, 2008), 249.

coming into manifestation as the God of redemption...he will be.”³⁶ Accordingly, Psalm 90:2 says, “Before the mountains were brought forth, or ever you had formed the earth and the world, from everlasting you are God.” Job 36:26 says, “the number of His years is unsearchable.”³⁷ In John 8:58, Jesus says: “I assure you: Before Abraham was, I am.” Hebrews 13:8 says that “Jesus Christ is the same yesterday, today, and forever.” In the Book of Revelation 1:8, Jesus says “‘I am the Alpha and the Omega,’ says the Lord God, ‘the One who is, who was, and who is coming, the Almighty’” and in 22:13 “I am the Alpha and the Omega, the First and the Last, the Beginning and the End.” In Revelation 4:8, the four living creatures “day and night... never stop” worshipping God vocally as the One who is “Holy, holy, holy, Lord God, the Almighty, who was, who is, and who is coming.”³⁸ Just as each of these verses echo, bottom line, the one idea the name YHWH expresses is that “GOD IS.”³⁹

Description

In various Scriptures, there are some general descriptions given of God’s name sacred name. In Psalm 8:1, 9, David proclaims that God’s name is “majestic... in all the earth.” In Psalm 52:9, David says it is “good.” In Psalm 75:1, Asaph says that God’s name is “near.” Psalm 102:12 says that God’s name “abide(s) to all generations.” Psalm 135:13 says that God’s name is “everlasting.” Proverbs 18:10 says that God’s name is a “strong tower.” In Jeremiah 10:6,

³⁶ Brown, 218.

³⁷ Grudem, Systematic Theology, 169.

³⁸ Holman Christian Standard Bible.

³⁹ McGee, J. Vernon. Thru the Bible Genesis through Deuteronomy. (Nashville: Thomas Nelson Publishers, 1981), 211.

Jeremiah says that God's name is "great...in might."⁴⁰

Construction of the Name

Looking specifically at the construction of YHWH, it has been referred to by scholars as the "Tetragrammaton." It is given this label because of its composure of the four Hebrew letters, יהוה (YHWH), in the fashion of yodth (י), he (ה), waw (ו), and he (ה), written right to left according to the custom of Hebrew, and with all consonants and no vowels. The pronunciation of it has been debated.⁴¹

Mispronunciation of the name as "Jehovah" began around the time of 1500.⁴² This mispronunciation was actually published in at least 7 verses of the King James Version.⁴³ What seems to have led to the pronunciation of "Jehovah," was the Masoretes supplying the vowels for either adonai or elohim rather than the actual vowels of YHWH in order to guard the sacredness of the correct pronunciation.⁴⁴ The vowels for adonai (Lord) would be supplied in all cases except for those cases when adonai preceded the name, YHWH, in which the vowels for elohim (God) would be supplied rather than those for adonai.⁴⁵ The Theological Dictionary of the Old Testament says that "Renaissance Christians" were either unaware of or intentionally overlooked

⁴⁰ New American Standard Bible.

⁴¹ Vine, *Vine's Complete Expository Dictionary* of Old and New Testament Words, 140.

⁴² Koehler, *The Hebrew and Aramaic Lexicon of the Old Testament*, 395.

⁴³ Strong, James and John R. Kohlenberger. *The New Strong's Expanded Exhaustive Concordance of the Bible*. (Nashville: Thomas Nelson Publishers, 2001), 446.

⁴⁴ Botterweck, *Theological Dictionary of the Old Testament*, 501.

⁴⁵ Ibid.

this Masoretic tendency.⁴⁶ This Masoretic practice began as early as the sixth or seventh century.⁴⁷ It would be a note to the reader to say the name adonai rather than the name YHWH when doing public reading in the synagogue.⁴⁸ Again, as mentioned earlier, the custom of not pronouncing the name YHWH goes all the way back to the time just after the Babylonian exile.⁴⁹ All of this led to what had been thought to be the loss of the proper pronunciation of YHWH.⁵⁰

Today, it has been “accepted almost universally” that “Yahweh” is the correct pronunciation.⁵¹ According to the Encyclopedia Judaica, “The true pronunciation of the name YHWH was never lost. Several Greek writers of the Christian church testify that the name was pronounced ‘Yahweh.’”⁵² Ray Clendenen says “The Christian theologian Clement of Alexandria (d. AD 215), for example, was apparently familiar with the Jewish tradition for how the divine name was pronounced ‘Yahweh.’”⁵³

There are a couple of other random things to be noted about the Hebrew construction of the name, Yahweh. One thing is that Yah, an abbreviated form of Yahweh, is found around 50 times throughout the Biblia Hebraica.⁵⁴ Another thing to be noted is that the grammatical form of the name Yahweh, according to the principles of Hebrew grammar, can be categorized as “a third

⁴⁶ Ibid.

⁴⁷ Ryrie, Basic Theology, 53.

⁴⁸ Ibid.

⁴⁹ Ibid.

⁵⁰ Berkhof, Systematic Theology, 49.

⁵¹ Botterweck, Theological Dictionary of the Old Testament, 500.

⁵² Clendenen, “Holman Christian Standard Bible (HCSB),” 154.

⁵³ Ibid.

⁵⁴ Zondervan NASB Exhaustive Concordance, 1401.

person imperfect qal or hiphil.”⁵⁵

When translating YHWH into Greek in the Septuagint (LXX), the Jews used the word kurios for “Lord” (congruent to the word adonai for “Lord” in Hebrew) whenever the name YHWH would occur in the Hebrew.⁵⁶ This idea has likewise been practiced by “most English translations.”⁵⁷ You can usually tell in an English translation where the name YHWH had occurred in the Hebrew by the presence of the word “LORD” in all caps.⁵⁸ The HCSB, as an exception to this, actually uses, in many occurrences, the very name, “Yahweh.” There are 611 uses of the name, “Yahweh” in the HCSB.⁵⁹

Commemorative Name

As cited earlier, the Biblical texts say Yahweh is God’s “memorial-name.”⁶⁰ The phrase “memorial-name” is from the Hebrew word, zeker which means: “memorial, i.e. name, by which one is brought to remembrance, mentioned.”⁶¹ This Hebrew term is used in description of God’s name, Yahweh, in five different occurrences throughout the Old Testament: Exodus 3:15, Psalm

⁵⁵ Berkhof, Systematic Theology, 49.

⁵⁶ Holman Bible Dictionary. (Nashville: Holman Bible Publishers, 1991), 890.

⁵⁷ Ibid., 1429.

⁵⁸ Ibid.

⁵⁹ [www.biblegateway.com, http://www.biblegateway.com/keyword/?search=Yahweh&version1=HCSB&searchtype=all&limit=none&wholewordsonly=no](http://www.biblegateway.com/keyword/?search=Yahweh&version1=HCSB&searchtype=all&limit=none&wholewordsonly=no) (accessed December 6, 2012)

⁶⁰ New American Standard Bible, Exodus 3:15.

⁶¹ Gesenius, William. A Hebrew and English Lexicon of Old Testament. (Boston: Crocker and Brewster, 1844), 284.

30:4, Psalm 97:12, Psalm 102:12, and Hosea 12:5.⁶² The last of these examples, Hosea 12:5 states: “The LORD, the God of hosts; the LORD is his memorial name.”⁶³

Combination Names

There are many different combination names or titles that are found throughout the whole of the Old Testament that include the name Yahweh. Below is a list of such names or titles:

1. Yahweh Elohim (Yahweh God) – This is the first combination name found in Old Testament and is actually found at the point of the first occurrence of the name, Yahweh. This combination occurs 40 times in the Old Testament altogether.⁶⁴
2. Adonai Yahweh (Lord Yahweh) – In the NASB, this is translated as “the Lord GOD.” This combination name occurs 315 times throughout the Old Testament.⁶⁵
3. Yahweh Elyon (Yahweh Most High) – This occurs at least 3-4 times in the Old Testament, one of the occurrences being “Yahweh God Most High.”⁶⁶
4. Yahweh Tsebaoth (Yahweh of Hosts) – This is found 229 times in the Old Testament and is translated in the NASB as “the LORD of Hosts.” It happens to be that over a third, 36%, of these 229 times (82 in all) occur in the last three books of the Old Testament alone.⁶⁷ The meaning of this title is somewhat uncertain. The word “Hosts” is debated to be 1 of 3 things: “the armies of Israel,” “the stars,” or “the angels.” L. Berkhof

⁶² Zondervan NASB Exhaustive Concordance, 723, 756-757.

⁶³ The Holy Bible, English Standard Version. (Wheaton: Crossway Bibles, 2001).

⁶⁴ Hamilton, Victor P. The Book of Genesis Chapters 1-17. (Grand Rapids: William B. Eerdmans Publishing Company, 1990), 152.

⁶⁵ Zondervan NASB Exhaustive Concordance, 1401.

⁶⁶ [www.biblegateway.com, http://www.biblegateway.com/keyword/?search=%22most+high%22&searchtype=phrase&version1=49&language1=en&spanbegin=1&spanend=73&resultspp=250](http://www.biblegateway.com/keyword/?search=%22most+high%22&searchtype=phrase&version1=49&language1=en&spanbegin=1&spanend=73&resultspp=250) (accessed December 7, 2012).

⁶⁷ [www.biblegateway.com, http://www.biblegateway.com/keyword/?search=%22LORD+of+Hosts%22&searchtype=phrase&version1=49&language1=en&spanbegin=1&spanend=73&resultspp=250](http://www.biblegateway.com/keyword/?search=%22LORD+of+Hosts%22&searchtype=phrase&version1=49&language1=en&spanbegin=1&spanend=73&resultspp=250) (accessed December 7, 2012).

indicates that the last option, “the angels,” is the most accurate choice.⁶⁸ An interesting Scripture that would correspond both to this and to the next listing is Joshua 5:14, which speaks of the “commander of the LORD’s army.”⁶⁹

5. Malak Yahweh (The Angel of Yahweh) – This specific phrase occurs 53 times throughout the Old Testament.⁷⁰ It is said that when this Being would appear that it was a “Christophany, a preincarnate appearance of Christ.”⁷¹

6. Yahweh Yireh (Yahweh will Provide) – This came about through the event of Abraham and Isaac on Mount Moriah in Genesis 22.⁷² “Yahweh will Provide” was the name given to this mountain, and it was said in verse 14: “It will be provided on the LORD’s mountain.”⁷³

7. Yahweh Rophe (Yahweh who Heals) – This is found in the Exodus 15 in a statement God made to the Israelites just following the crossing of the Red Sea.⁷⁴

8. Yahweh Nissi (Yahweh is My Banner) – This is found in Exodus 17:15.⁷⁵

9. Yahweh Shalom (Yahweh is Peace) – This is found in Judges 6:24.⁷⁶

10. Yahweh Maccaddeshcem (Yahweh who Sanctifies) – This is found in Exodus 31:13.⁷⁷

⁶⁸ Berkhof, Systematic Theology, 49-50.

⁶⁹ Holman Christian Standard Bible.

⁷⁰ www.biblegateway.com,
<http://www.biblegateway.com/keyword/?search=%22the+angel+of+the+LORD%22&searchtype=phrase&version1=49&language1=en&spanbegin=1&spanend=73&resultspp=250> (accessed December 7, 2012).

⁷¹ Ryrie, Basic Theology, 149.

⁷² Ibid., 54.

⁷³ Holman Christian Standard Bible.

⁷⁴ Spangler, Ann. Praying the Names of God: A Daily Guide. (Waterville: Walker Large Print, 2004), 132-133.

⁷⁵ Ryrie, Basic Theology, 54.

⁷⁶ Ibid.

⁷⁷ Ibid.

11. Yahweh Roi (Yahweh is My Shepherd) – This is found in Psalm 23:1.⁷⁸
12. Yahweh Tsur (Yahweh is My Rock) – This is found in Psalm 144:1.⁷⁹
13. Yahweh Tsidkenu (Yahweh our Righteousness) – This is found in Jeremiah 23:6.⁸⁰
14. Yahweh Shammah (Yahweh is There) This is to be the name of the city that is described at the last verse of Ezekiel, Ezekiel 48:35.⁸¹

All of these just mentioned are found in the Old Testament. Are there any such titles or statements in the New Testament to assist in better understanding the Yahweh of the Old Testament? Essentially, as discussed earlier, the names “Yahweh” and “I AM” are synonymous and are basically one in the same. The title, “I AM” is certainly present in the New Testament, specifically in John and Revelation. To follow are the “I AM” statements found in John: 1) “I AM” (8:58, 13:13) 2) “I AM He” (4:26, 8:24, 8:28, 13:19, 18:5) 3) “I AM the Bread of Life” (6:35, 48, also 41, 51) 4) “I AM the Light of the World” (8:12, 9:5) 5) “I AM the Good Shepherd” (10:7, 11, 14) 6) “I AM the Door” (10:9) 7) “I AM the Resurrection and the Life” (11:25) 8) “I AM the Way, the Truth, and the Life.” (14:6) 9) “I AM the True Vine” and in Revelation: 10) “I AM Alive Forever and Ever” (1:18) 11) “I AM the One Who Examines Minds and Hearts” (2:23) 12) “I AM Making Everything New” (21:5) 13) “I AM the Alpha and the Omega, the First and the Last, the Beginning and the End” (22:13, also 1:8, 1:17, and 21:6) 14) “I AM the Root and the Offspring of David, the Bright Morning Star” (22:16).⁸²

⁷⁸ Ibid.

⁷⁹ Spangler, *Praying the Names of God: A Daily Guide*, 239.

⁸⁰ Ryrie, *Basic Theology*, 54.

⁸¹ Ibid.

⁸² Holman Christian Standard Bible.

Compound Names

There is a great number of what is referred to as compound names or compound words that with intentionality had some form of the name, Yahweh, as part of the word. Examples of these are found all throughout the Old Testament. Each one of these names/words would basically only have part of the name Yahweh, but that form would be representative of the whole in each name/word. As prefixes of a name/word, it would be likely to find either yo- or y^eho- affixed to the beginning of each such name/word.⁸³ Examples of this would be yehoash – Yah is strong (the name of Joash, king of Judah), yehoshaphat – “Yah has judged” (the name of Jehoshaphat, another king of Judah), and yoel – “Yah is God” (the name of Joel the prophet).⁸⁴ As suffixes of a name/word, it would be likely to find either -yahu or -yah affixed to the ending of each such name/word.⁸⁵ Examples of this would be maaseyahu and maaseyah⁸⁶ – “work of Yah” and malkiyahu and malkiyah⁸⁷ – “my king is Yah” (each found in both forms, both meaning the same thing). Another example of a compound word ending with the suffix yah is the word hal^elu-yah –praise Yah (found in verse 6 at the end of Psalm 150 among multiple other places at the end of the Book of Psalms).⁸⁸ A Greek transliteration of this word is found in four different places in the Book of Revelation as well.⁸⁹

⁸³ Botterweck, *Theological Dictionary of the Old Testament*, 501.

⁸⁴ Zondervan NASB Exhaustive Concordance, 1401.

⁸⁵ Botterweck, *Theological Dictionary of the Old Testament*, 501.

⁸⁶ Ibid.

⁸⁷ Ibid.

⁸⁸ Parallel Bible Hebrew-English Old Testament, The. (Peabody: Hendrickson Publishers, 2003), Psalm 150:6.

⁸⁹ Vine, *Vine's Complete Expository Dictionary of Old and New Testament Words*, 287.

There is another such compound name that is of most significance. The Bible informs that “there is no other name under heaven that has been given among men by which we must be saved” and that at this name “EVERY KNEE WILL BOW, of those who are in heaven and on earth and under the earth.”⁹⁰ The name is Jesus. Matthew 1:21 says “you shall call His name Jesus, for He will save His people from their sins.”⁹¹ What was the significant connection between Jesus being named as He was and Him saving His people from their sins? The name Yahweh is found close to 7,000 times in the Old Testament, but is it found even once in the New Testament? If not, why not? Did God’s personal, “memorial-name” become obsolete and suddenly out of circulation at the turn of the New Testament? Jesus’ name is found close to 1,000 times in the New Testament (990),⁹² and for every time the name Jesus is found so is the name Yahweh. The name Jesus is a compound name of the Hebrew name Yahweh (Yah [Je-]) and the Hebrew word for salvation (hoshea [-sus])⁹³ – Yah is salvation, the literal meaning of Jesus’ name.⁹⁴ Our English “Jesus” is from the Greek ’Iesous.⁹⁵ The Greek ’Iesous is from the Old Testament word for Joshua⁹⁶

⁹⁰ New American Standard Bible, Acts 4:12 and Philippians 2:10.

⁹¹ New American Standard Bible.

⁹² [www.biblegateway.com](http://www.biblegateway.com/quicksearch/?quicksearch=Jesus&qv_version=NASB),
http://www.biblegateway.com/quicksearch/?quicksearch=Jesus&qv_version=NASB, (accessed December 7, 2012).

⁹³ Bullinger, E. W. *A Critical Lexicon and Concordance to the English and Greek Testament*. (London: Samuel Bagster and Sons Limited, 1969), 422.

⁹⁴ Vine, *Vine’s Complete Expository Dictionary of Old and New Testament Words*, 333.

⁹⁵ *The Greek New Testament*, Fourth Revised Edition. (Stuttgart: United Bible Societies, 1998), Matthew 1:21.

⁹⁶ *Septuaginta: Id est Vestus Testamentum graece iuxta LSS interpretes*. Duo volumina in uno. Editit Alfred Rahlfs. (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1979), Exodus 17:9.

(more precisely Yehoshuah in the Hebrew).⁹⁷ The Hebrew word Yehoshua broken down is Ye (Yah/Yahweh) + hoshuah/hoshea (salvation) = Yahweh is salvation.⁹⁸ The name Yahweh did not drop off the pages of Scripture at the turn of the New Testament. It has actually been maintained, enhanced, further developed and further unveiled in its fuller meaning as “Jesus” (‘Iesous) in the New Testament.

Direction (Conclusion)

In conclusion, there is an “I AM” statement previously unmentioned that is actually found at the end of the Gospel of Matthew in 28:20. The statement is “I AM with You Always, to the End of the Earth.”⁹⁹ Not only is God the God Who Is, the God Who Exists, but He also wants to give confident assurance of both His existence and His being with us. At the beginning of the same book in Matthew 1:23, it says “‘AND THEY SHALL CALL HIS NAME IMMANUEL,’ which translated means, ‘GOD WITH US.’”¹⁰⁰ Creation points to who He is as Yahweh, to His existence, and Christmas points to who He is specifically as Yahweh is Salvation (Jesus), to His wanting to be with us. A final “I AM” statement, still unmentioned, is found at the end of the Book of Revelation, at the conclusion the Bible in its entirety. It is first stated in Revelations 3:11 and repeated 3 more times in Revelation 22. The repeated statement is “I AM Coming Quickly.”¹⁰¹ In between the statement in chapter 3 and the repeated statements in chapter 22 is the statement:

⁹⁷ Zondervan NASB Exhaustive Concordance, 1401.

⁹⁸ Ibid.

⁹⁹ New American Standard Bible. (All emphasized caps are the author’s emphasis.)

¹⁰⁰ Ibid.

¹⁰¹ Ibid.

“I AM Coming like a Thief.”¹⁰² As one looks to His soon and sudden coming, one must be sure and certain of two things, and more so and increasingly so as that day approaches. The two things are reflective of this study of His name: both His existence and His being with us.

¹⁰² Ibid., Revelation 16:15.

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